

All eyes on Hong Kong in May

We see a solid Q1 25 as a staging post to the main near term catalyst of new medium term targets to be delivered in Hong Kong in May. We model a '28E ROTE of 17% and would expect management to guide to a medium term ROTE of >15%. We model \$16bn of total capital returns '26-28E, 10% per annum with 23% TBV/share growth through 2028. Shares on 1.2x '27E TBV.

We believe the 19-21 May investor seminar in Hong Kong represents a meaningful catalyst for STAN given management will present medium-term aspirations for the group. Our modeling suggests a 17% ROTE by 2028, predicated on 6% revenue CAGR (non-interest income CAGR 10%; net interest income CAGR of 2%) and 200bps of positive operating leverage. Against this we model a normalization of credit costs though still 29bps (for context, management's existing guidance is 30-35bps through the cycle). For 2026-2028E, we model \$16bn of capital remuneration, around 30% of current market cap. We would expect management to target a >15% or higher ROTE over the plan period (likely through 2028).

The key to convincing investors and thus serving to re-rate the shares to a more appropriate multiple as compared to the current 1.1x forward P/TBV (and 6.5x '27E earnings), will be the bridge to a >15% ROTE from the 12% reported for 2025. Our expectation is that ROTE improvement is revenue & mix led, but investors are likely to scrutinize the cost trajectory as well. Whilst management have a good track record at delivering operating leverage, there is a debate in the investment community about whether there are further opportunities to structurally remove costs.

HK is back. Our [March visit to Hong Kong](#) suggests that there is much more to the story than HK as a wealth venue. The footings of the HK economy seem more compelling to this analyst than they have been in at least 15 years. This stance arises from Beijing's 15th 5-year plan which, among other factors, seeks to integrate China tech globally - this will require international capital to mobilize and that leads to the broader topic of Beijing's renewed focus on RMB internationalization which should be supportive of revenue growth in STAN's CIB.

As for Q1 26 earnings, we envisage a pre-provision result modestly above consensus driven by better NII and with ongoing strength in Wealth (we model Wealth Solutions revenue up 20% YoY) and circa 7% YoY revenue growth in Markets, implying a material pickup QoQ as so-called Episodic revenue recovers and underlying flow improves. The wild card will be on credit costs where the underlying picture is benign but we would expect some caution around the Iran War. On this point, STAN's FY 25 balance sheet provision included \$202m of management overlays including \$47m for HK CRE which is likely no longer required. Further, any higher levels of provisioning would have a limited knock on impact on CET1 given the excess expected loss over provisions was \$599m. The point is that there is already some buffer in STAN's existing provisioning/CET1 capital.

FY (Dec)	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E
Rev. (MM)	20,942.0	22,133.0	23,528.0	24,898.0
Dividend	39.00	68.00	76.00	86.00
Div. Yield	NM	NM	NM	NM
EPS	195.40	217.90	308.00	358.30

TARGET ESTIMATE CHANGE	
RATING	BUY
PRICE	1,806.00p*
PRICE TARGET % TO PT	↑ 2,250.00p (1,640.00p) +25%
52W HIGH-LOW	1,924p - 1,007p
FLOAT (%) ADV MM (USD)	80.1% 246.90
MARKET CAP	£40.6B \$54.9B
TICKER	STAN LN

*Prior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

FY (Dec)	CHANGE TO JEF		JEF vs CONS	
	2026	2027	2026	2027
REV	NM	+2%	+1%	+1%
EPS	-9%	-3%	-1%	+12%

Consensus: Visible Alpha
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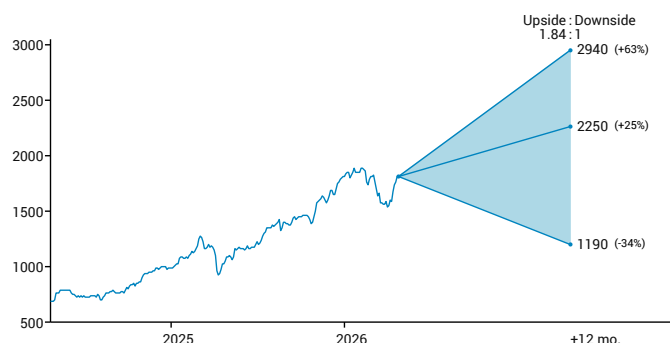
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The Long View: Standard Chartered PLC

Investment Thesis

A bottom-up investment opportunity arises in STAN, given that its Wealth business should continue to benefit from structural trends in its footprint, financial markets business should continue to benefit from volatility plus see some support from structural factors such as RMB internationalization. Management has a track record of delivering operating leverage and no further disruptive restructuring is anticipated. All of this contributes to earnings estimates ahead of consensus.

Risk/Reward - 12 Month View



Base Case, 2250p, +25%

- Revenue CAGR 25-28e: +6.0%;
- NIM% '28e: 1.90%;
- Cost Of Risk '28e: 0.29%;
- Cost Income '28e: 53%;
- '28e DPS: 85.6c;
- '28e CET1: 14.3%;
- '26-28e Buybacks: \$11.5bn;
- '28e RoTE (stat): 17.0%
- '28e TBVps: 2,130c;
- Growth rate 2%;
- Ke: 10.5%

Upside Scenario, 2940p, +63%

- Revenue CAGR 25-28e: +8.7%;
- NIM% '28e: 1.90%;
- Cost Of Risk '28e: 0.25%;
- Cost Income '28e: 61%;
- '28e DPS: 85.6c
- '28e CET1: 14.1%;
- '26-28e Buybacks: \$14.0bn;
- '28e RoTE (stat): 18.7%
- '28e TBVps: 2,416c;
- Growth rate 2%;
- Ke: 10.0%

Downside Scenario, 1190p, -34%

- Revenue CAGR 25-28e: +2.8%;
- NIM% '28e: 1.82%;
- Cost Of Risk '28e: 0.35%;
- Cost Income '28e: 69%;
- '28e DPS: 83.6c
- '28e CET1: 15.1%;
- '26-28e Buybacks: \$11.5bn;
- '28e RoTE (stat): 12.9%
- '28e TBVps: 1,917c;
- Growth rate 2%;
- Ke: 12.0%

Sustainability Matters

Top Material Issues:

- 1) Following the GFC, regulators, working in concert with governments, created a more rigorous ever-evolving framework of capital and liquidity requirements. How regulators will implement ESG factors into these requirements will be a critical concern.
- 2) Fines have become a key tool used by banking regulators, with global banking fines since the GFC exceeding \$300bn. How effectively Banks' adopt ESG-responsible practices, particularly consumer protection, will likely determine how exposed they will be to potential regulatory actions in the future.

Company Targets:

- 1) Net zero own operations emissions by 2025;
- 2) Provide green and transition financing of \$300bn by 2030;
- 3) Invest 0.75% of prior year operating profit in local communities.

Catalysts

- 30 April 2026 - Q1 26 earnings
- 19-21 May 2026 - Investor Seminar
- 29 July 2026 - Q2 26 earnings

Qs for Mgmt:

- 1) What is the strategy for carbon-intensive lending portfolios; what is the near-term & long-term % of group lending?;
- 2) What ESG financing opportunities, and how meaningful to the bank's performance, is the bank undertaking (green and transition finance, impact finance, Socio-economic mobility programs)?

ESG Sector Deep Dive: Banks

Exhibit 1 - Changes in JEF estimates

Changes in JEF estimates	JEFe			Prev.		Δ JEFe	
PnL [Co. Format] (\$bn)	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
NII [underlying]	11,408	11,771	11,940	10,951	11,119	+4%	+6%
Non-NII [underlying]	10,705	11,738	12,938	11,096	12,044	-4%	-3%
Total Income	22,133	23,528	24,898	22,043	23,160	+0%	+2%
Operating Costs	-12,414	-12,835	-13,268	-12,114	-12,495	+2%	+3%
UK Bank Levy	-100	-100	-100	-100	-100	-	-
Total Opex	-13,315	-12,935	-13,368	-12,799	-12,595	+4%	+3%
Pre-prov op profit [underlying]	8,818	10,593	11,529	9,243	10,565	-5%	+0%
Credit Impairments/(recoveries)	-915	-1,049	-1,081	-1,136	-1,079	-19%	-3%
Profit from associates & JVs	120	120	120	-	-		
PBT [stat]	8,022	9,665	10,568	8,228	9,606	-2%	+1%
Balance Sheet (\$bn)							
Loans (excl. FVTPL)	299	309	318	296	305	+1%	+1%
RWAs	270	273	279	264	269	+3%	+2%
Franchise Indicators							
EPS [stat]	218	308	358	239	318	-9%	-3%
TBVPS (\$ cents)	1,780	1,942	2,130	1,909	2,217	-7%	-12%
ROTE % [stat]	12.3%	16.0%	17.0%	13.2%	15.5%	-90bps	+50bps
Cost of Risk (incl. FVTPL)	0.26%	0.29%	0.29%	0.32%	0.30%	-6bps	-1bps
Cost Income [stat]	60%	55%	54%	58%	54%	+2ppts	+1ppts
CET1 % [transitional]	13.7%	14.1%	14.3%	14.1%	14.7%	-40bps	-60bps
Capital Return							
DPS (cents)	68	76	86	41	45	+67%	+70%
Buybacks [declared] (\$bn)	3.0	4.0	4.5	3.0	3.0	-	+33%
TSR (\$bn)	4.5	5.6	6.2	3.8	3.8	-	-

Source: Company reports, Jefferies estimates

Exhibit 2 - STAN - Jef vs VA Consensus

JEF Vs VA. Consensus	Jef Est				VA Cons (22-Apr)				Δ JEF vs VA Cons			
PnL [Co. Format] (\$bn)	1Q26E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	1Q26E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	1Q26E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Net Interest Income (adjusted)	2,866	11,408	11,771	11,940	2,778	11,186	11,491	12,079	+3%	+2%	+2%	-1%
Non-Interest Income (adjusted)	2,812	10,705	11,738	12,938	2,774	10,686	11,535	12,297	+1%	+0%	+2%	+5%
Total Income (adjusted)	5,678	22,113	23,508	24,878	5,552	21,872	23,025	24,377	+2%	+1%	+2%	+2%
Net Interest Income (reported)	1,541	6,108	7,771	7,940	1,417	5,843	6,346	6,741	+9%	+5%	+22%	+18%
Non-Interest Income (reported)	4,142	16,025	15,758	16,958	4,186	16,032	16,854	17,733	-1%	-0%	-7%	-4%
Total Income (reported)	5,683	22,133	23,528	24,898	5,603	21,875	23,200	24,474	+1%	+1%	+1%	+2%
Operating Expenses (reported)	-3,354	-13,315	-12,935	-13,368	-3,366	-13,891	-13,356	-13,805	-0%	-4%	-3%	-3%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,329	8,818	10,593	11,529	2,238	7,984	9,844	10,668	+4%	+10%	+8%	+8%
Credit impairment	-255	-915	-1,049	-1,081	-271	-998	-1,081	-1,132	-6%	-8%	-3%	-5%
PBT [reported]	2,104	8,022	9,665	10,568	2,153	7,770	8,793	9,601	-2%	+3%	+10%	+10%
Balance Sheet (\$bn)												
Loans (excl. FVTPL)	292	299	309	318	289	295	306	319	+1%	+1%	+1%	-0%
Deposits (excl. FVTPL)	561	586	629	671	540	557	582	605	+4%	+5%	+8%	+11%
RWAs	266	270	273	279	261	266	276	287	+2%	+2%	-1%	-3%
Franchise Indicators												
EPS [stat] (cents)	58.5	218	308	358	58.7	220	274	315	-0%	-1%	+12%	+14%
TNAV per share (cents)	1,744	1,780	1,942	2,130	1,741	1,854	2,022	2,223	+0%	-4%	-4%	-4%
ROTE (%) [reported]	13.7%	12.3%	16.0%	17.0%	13.5%	12.7%	14.2%	14.9%	+20bps	-40bps	+180bps	+210bps
NIM (%) - adjusted	2.05%	1.97%	1.95%	1.90%	1.97%	1.95%	1.94%	1.98%	+8bps	+2bps	+1bps	-8bps
Cost of Risk (%)	0.36%	0.31%	0.35%	0.34%	0.37%	0.34%	0.36%	0.36%	-1bps	-3bps	-1bps	-2bps
Cost Income Ratio [reported] (%)	59%	60%	55%	54%	60%	64%	58%	56%	-1ppts	-3ppts	-3ppts	-3ppts
CET1 %	13.6%	13.7%	14.1%	14.3%	13.9%	14.0%	14.2%	14.4%	-30bps	-30bps	-10bps	-10bps
Capital Return												
DPS (cents per share)	-	68.3	76.5	85.6	-	65.3	78.1	91.3		+5%	-2%	-6%
Share buybacks [Executed] (\$bn)	0.5	2.8	3.0	4.0	0.7	2.7	2.5	2.6	-32%	+4%	+21%	+56%
Total Shareholder Return (\$bn)	0.5	4.5	5.6	6.2	0.7	4.1	4.1	4.4	-32%	+9%	+36%	+41%

Source: VA, Jefferies estimates

Exhibit 3 - JEF estimates

Summary of Jef estimates												Upside	2250	+26%
JEFe: Standard Chartered Plc (STAN)														
PnL [stat] (\$m)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Net Interest Income	1,581	1,463	1,408	1,503	1,541	1,495	1,533	1,539	7,769	6,366	5,955	6,108	7,771	7,940
Non-Interest Income	3,798	4,064	3,702	3,423	4,142	4,157	4,066	3,660	10,250	13,177	14,987	16,025	15,758	16,958
Total Income	5,379	5,527	5,110	4,926	5,683	5,652	5,599	5,200	18,019	19,543	20,942	22,133	23,528	24,898
Operating Costs	-3,046	-3,201	-3,144	-3,913	-3,354	-3,356	-3,288	-3,217	-11,440	-12,412	-13,304	-13,215	-12,835	-13,268
UK Bank Levy	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-100	-111	-90	-	-100	-100	-100
Total Opex	-3,046	-3,201	-3,144	-3,913	-3,354	-3,356	-3,288	-3,317	-11,551	-12,502	-13,304	-13,315	-12,935	-13,368
Pre-Provision Operating Profit	2,333	2,326	1,966	1,013	2,329	2,295	2,311	1,883	6,468	7,041	7,638	8,818	10,593	11,529
Credit Impairment	-217	-119	-188	-148	-255	-224	-217	-219	-508	-547	-672	-915	-1,049	-1,081
Other Impairment	-15	-4	-22	-24	-	-	-	-	-1,008	-588	-65	-	-	-
Profit From Associates & JVs	2	77	10	-27	30	30	30	30	141	108	62	120	120	120
PBT	2,103	2,280	1,766	814	2,104	2,102	2,123	1,694	5,093	6,014	6,963	8,022	9,665	10,568
Tax [stat]	-511	-546	-468	-341	-675	-694	-701	-572	-1,631	-1,972	-1,866	-2,641	-2,893	-3,165
PAT [stat]	1,592	1,734	1,298	473	1,429	1,408	1,423	1,122	3,462	4,042	5,097	5,381	6,771	7,404
Non-controlling Interests	-2	-15	2	3	-8	-8	-8	-8	7	8	-12	-30	-30	-30
Other Equity Holders	-233	-11	-272	-11	-113	-113	-220	-113	-452	-457	-527	-558	-450	-450
Attributable Profit [stat]	1,357	1,708	1,028	465	1,309	1,288	1,195	1,002	3,017	3,593	3,727	4,794	6,291	6,924

Balance Sheet (\$bn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Loans (excl. FVTPL)	282	287	285	287	292	296	297	299	287	281	287	299	309	318
Total Assets	874	914	914	920	901	939	943	949	823	850	874	902	928	954
Deposits (excl. FVTPL & Repos)	491	517	526	530	561	582	584	586	469	464	530	586	629	671
RWAs	254	260	258	258	266	268	269	270	244	247	258	270	273	279
Tangible Book Value	37	39	39	39	39	39	40	38	37	37	38	38	40	41
Avg. Loans	281	284	286	286	289	294	296	298	293	283	284	294	304	314
AIEA	536	547	560	560	567	580	584	589	573	539	551	580	604	628

Per share ratios (\$ cents)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
EPS [stat]	56.6	72.5	44.5	20.4	58.5	57.9	54.2	45.9	108.6	141.3	195.4	217.9	308.0	358.3
TBVPs	1,561	1,680	1,684	1,730	1,744	1,797	1,894	1,910	1,393	1,541	1,730	1,780	1,942	2,130
BVPS	1,806	1,941	1,952	2,007	2,011	2,032	2,088	2,065	1,629	1,779	1,963	2,069	2,245	2,453
Shares [p/e] (millions)	2,384	2,330	2,293	2,247	2,232	2,215	2,198	2,172	2,637	2,408	2,247	2,153	2,057	1,932

Banking Performance Ratios	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
ROTE % [stat]	14.8%	17.9%	10.5%	4.8%	13.7%	13.1%	11.7%	9.6%	8.4%	9.7%	11.9%	12.3%	16.0%	17.0%
NIM (%)	2.12%	1.98%	1.94%	2.09%	2.05%	1.95%	1.94%	1.93%	1.79%	2.06%	2.03%	1.97%	1.95%	1.90%
Cost of Risk (%)	0.26%	0.13%	0.22%	0.17%	0.29%	0.25%	0.24%	0.24%	0.15%	0.16%	0.19%	0.26%	0.29%	0.29%
Cost income ratio (%)	54%	55%	57%	71%	56%	56%	55%	60%	64%	60%	58%	57%	55%	54%
LDR %	62%	60%	59%	60%	58%	56%	56%	56%	65%	65%	60%	56%	54%	52%
Regulatory Capital Ratios	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
CET1 %	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.1%	13.6%	13.8%	14.1%	14.0%	14.1%	14.2%	14.1%	13.7%	14.1%	14.3%
CET1 % [pro-forma]	13.8%	13.8%	14.2%	13.5%	13.6%	13.3%	14.1%	13.3%	13.6%	13.8%	13.5%	13.0%	13.2%	13.2%
RWA/Loans	90.0%	90.6%	90.6%	90.0%	91.2%	90.8%	90.6%	90.4%	85.1%	87.9%	90.0%	90.4%	88.6%	87.6%
Excess CET1 (vs Target) (\$bn)	2.2	2.2	3.0	1.4	1.7	0.9	2.8	0.9	1.6	2.0	1.4	0.1	0.4	0.5

Capital & Shareholder Return	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
DPS (cents)	-	12.3	-	48.6	-	22.8	-	45.5	27.0	37.0	60.9	68.3	76.5	85.6
Buybacks [declared] (\$m)	-	1,300	-	1,500	-	1,300	-	1,700	2,000	3,000	2,800	3,000	4,000	4,500
Total Shareholder Return (\$m)	-	1,587	-	2,592	-	1,804	-	2,689	2,722	3,904	4,179	4,470	5,573	6,155
TSR (% of Mkt Cap)	-	4%	-	5%	-	3%	-	5%	12%	13%	8%	8%	10%	12%

Source: Company reports, Jefferies estimates

Our price target on STAN moves from 1640p to 2250p. 450p of the move is related to cost of equity falling from 12.4% to 10.5% and the remainder related to roll forward to 2028 numbers (from 2027) whereby ROTE goes to 17.0% from 15.5%. The difference is presented in the Exhibits below.

Exhibit 4 - STAN - JEF's price target methodology

Valuation calc	FY28E
Cost of Equity (Ke)	10.5%
Long term growth rate (g)	2%
Period end Date	31/12/2028
Date to discount to	22/04/2026
Discount Rate	76%
ROTE % [adj]	16.9%
TBVPS	2.130
Target P/TBV	18x
Tangible Value per Share (Future Value)	3,760
Tangible Value per Share (Present Value)	2,876
DPS (Reported)	85.64
Dividends paid	-
DPS (Future Value)	85.64
DPS (Present Value)	65.51
Present Value of future dividends	168
Valuation (cents)	3,043
Valuation (pence)	2,250
Upside/(downside)	+26%
Current Share price (pence)	1780p
Mkt Cap (£bn)	£39.6bn
Current Share price (\$ cents)	2,403
Mkt Cap (\$bn)	\$53.4bn
GBP USD pe	135

Source: Jefferies estimates

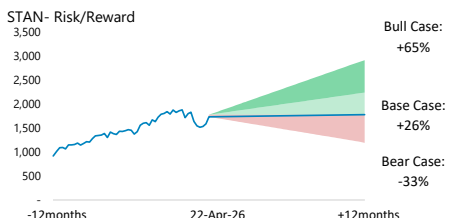
Exhibit 5 - STAN - JEF's prior price target methodology

Valuation calc	FY27E
Cost of Equity (Ke)	12%
Long term growth rate (g)	2%
Period end Date	31/12/2027
Date to discount to	28/07/2025
Discount Rate	75%
ROTE % [adj]	15.5%
TBVPS	2.27
Target P/TBV	13x
Tangible Value per Share (Future Value)	2,869
Tangible Value per Share (Present Value)	2,158
DPS (Reported)	44.87
Dividends paid	-
DPS (Future Value)	44.87
DPS (Present Value)	33.76
Present Value of future dividends	93
Valuation (cents)	2,251
Valuation (pence)	1,640
Upside/(downside)	+22%
Current Share price (pence)	1346p
Mkt Cap (£bn)	£32.4bn
Current Share price (\$ cents)	1844
Mkt Cap (\$bn)	\$44.4bn
GBP USD pe	137

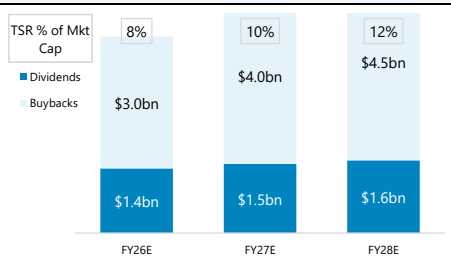
Source: Jefferies estimates

Exhibit 6 - STAN - Jef Valuation Table, Long View & Estimates vs Targets/Guidance

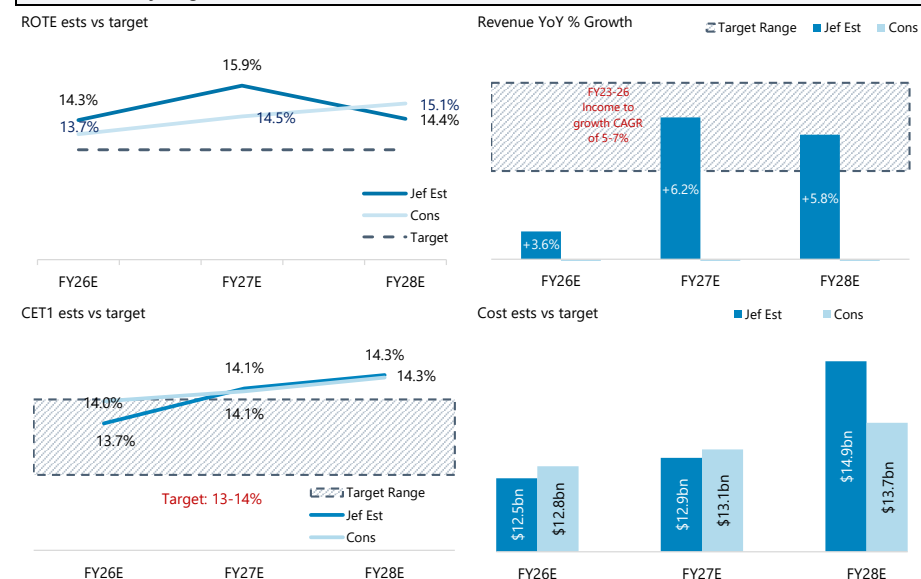
Jef Valuation Table & Long View			
Valuation calc	Base Case	Bull	Bear
Cost of Equity (Ke)	10.5%	10.0%	12.0%
Growth rate (g)	2%	2%	2%
'26e ROTE % [adj]	16.9%	18.7%	12.9%
'26e TBVPS	2,130	2,416	1,917
Target P/TBV	1.8x	2.1x	1.1x
Valuation	2,250	2,940	1,190
Upside/downside	+26%	+65%	-33%



Key Estimates & Capital return			
Jef Estimates	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
EPS [stat]	218	308	358
ROTE % [stat]	12.3%	16.0%	17.0%
TBVPS	1,780	1,942	2,130
Revenue YoY%	+4%	+6%	+6%
DPS (cents)	68	76	86
Dividend yield %	3%	4%	4%
Buybacks (declared)	\$3.0bn	\$4.0bn	\$4.5bn
CET1 %	13.7%	14.1%	14.3%



Estimates vs Key Targets/Guidance



Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha, Jefferies estimates

Company Description

Standard Chartered PLC

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Company Valuation/Risks

Standard Chartered PLC

We value STAN using a Gordon Growth methodology and apply a 12% Ke & 2% growth rate to our ests. Risks to our positive stance include a meaningful deterioration in revenues or drastic deterioration in the credit backdrop.

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Investment Recommendation Record

(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

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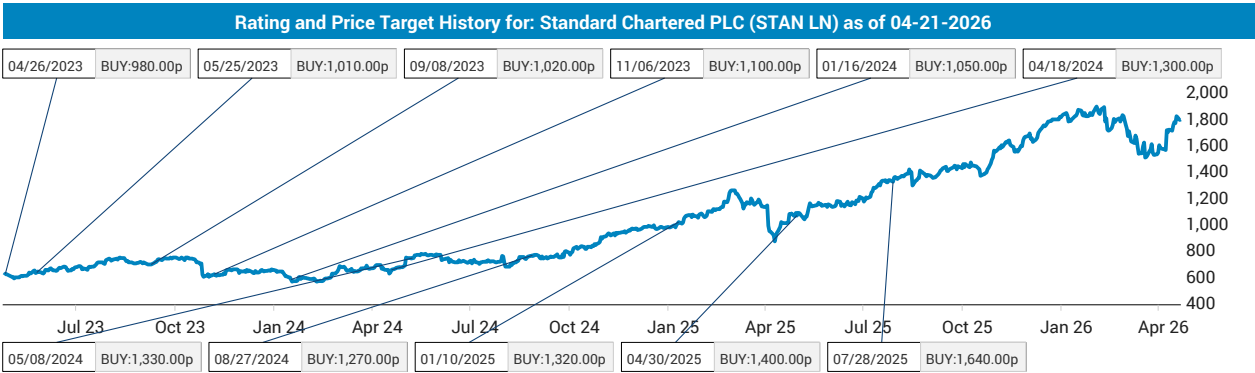
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Legend:

I: Initiating Coverage

D: Dropped Coverage

B: Buy

H: Hold

UP: Underperform

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			IB Serv./Past12 Mos.		JIL Mkt Serv./Past12 Mos.	
	Count	Percent	Count	Percent	Count	Percent
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